

Biometric Steering Wheel System Guide

Every part of the working system — sensor, ESP32 firmware, signal processing, Raspberry Pi relay, phone app, warning and emergency system, cloud database and live website — with setup instructions for any Linux machine, test results and references.



Branch
luis/full-system

Live dashboard
smart-wheel-dashboard.vercel.app

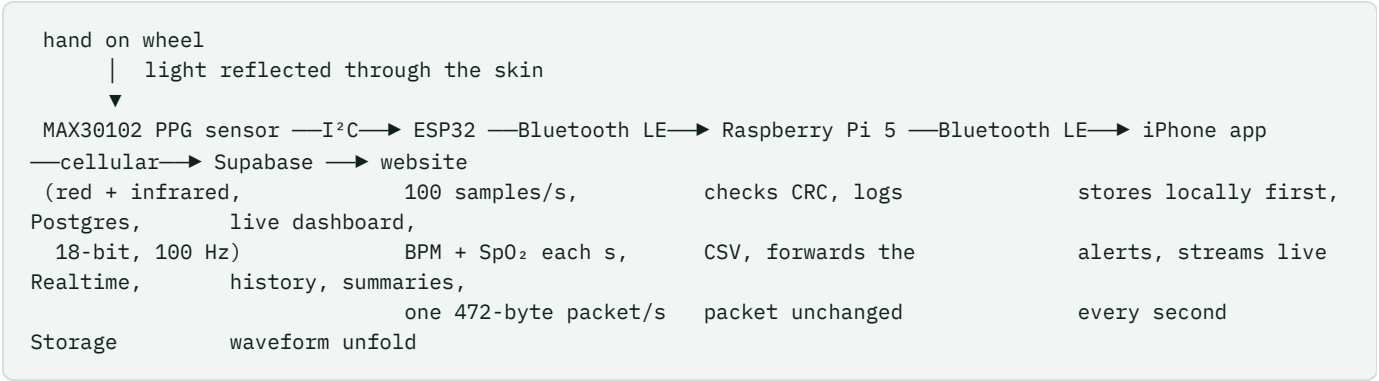
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1. The system in one picture



PART	RUNS	WHERE THE CODE IS
Sensor + ESP32	Arduino C++	system/esp32/ppg_transmitter/
Pi relay + terminal dashboard	Python 3 (asyncio, bleak, dbus-fast, rich)	system/pi/
Laptop viewer (bench tool)	Python 3 (PySide6, pyqtgraph)	system/laptop/
Shared protocol code	Python	system/common/ (copied into pi/ and laptop/)
Phone app	React Native + Expo SDK 54, TypeScript	mobile-app/
Database	Supabase (Postgres 17, Realtime, Storage)	mobile-app/supabase/*.sql
Website	Vite + vanilla JS, uPlot, fflate	website/

Key design ideas

- **Only the phone needs the internet.** In the car the ESP32 and the Pi talk only over Bluetooth. The phone uses its cellular data to reach Supabase.
- **Nothing is lost when there is no signal.** The phone saves every reading locally first, then uploads. Uploads are retried, and the same row can be sent twice without creating a duplicate.
- **Errors are caught end to end.** The ESP32 adds a CRC-16 checksum to every packet. The Pi forwards packets byte-for-byte, and the phone checks the ESP32's checksum again. Corruption anywhere on the path is detected.

2. Hardware: sensor and ESP32

ITEM	DETAIL
Microcontroller	ESP32-D0WD-V3 (rev 3.1) dev board, CP210x USB-serial (USB ID <code>10c4:ea60</code>)
Sensor	MAX30102 pulse-oximetry module, I ² C address <code>0x57</code> (PART_ID reads <code>0x15</code>)
Wiring	module 3V3 → ESP32 3V3 , GND → GND , SDA → GPIO 21 , SCL → GPIO 22
Pi	Raspberry Pi 5, Raspberry Pi OS, Bluetooth + Wi-Fi from its onboard Infineon CYW43455

Wiring notes from the bench:

- SCL must be on **GPIO 22**. On GPIO 23 the sensor is not found. The firmware prints I²C diagnostics if the sensor is missing: which addresses answer, and whether the module's pull-up resistors are visible.
- **Car power.** The ESP32 runs from the car's 12 V through a 12 V → 5 V USB adapter. The Pi should get an ignition-switched supply. Sudden power loss can corrupt the Pi's SD card, so a UPS HAT or a supercapacitor plus an ignition-sense line is recommended before real use.

3. ESP32 firmware

File: `system/esp32/ppg_transmitter/ppg_transmitter.ino`, with `ppg_frame.h` (packet encoder) and `ppg_vitals.h` (heart rate and SpO₂).

What it does every second:

1. **Reads the sensor FIFO directly** (registers `0x04 – 0x07`). The sensor samples at **100 Hz**: SpO₂ mode, 411 μ s LED pulse, 18-bit ADC, 4096 nA range. The datasheet allows 50/100/200/400 sps at 411 μ s. SparkFun's `getRed()/getIR()` are not used. Measured on this board, they block and return the *newest* sample, which ran acquisition 2.5 $\times$ slow and paired red and IR values from different moments.
2. **Keeps all 100 raw samples** for the packet.
3. **Averages groups of 4 samples into a 25 Hz series** (decimation) for the vitals estimator and keeps an 8-second history.
4. **Estimates heart rate and SpO₂** (see §4). The finger check uses the infrared (IR) DC level, which must be at least **100 000**.
5. **Builds a v3 packet** (§5): 472 bytes, CRC-16. It sends the packet in pieces sized to the Bluetooth link, because the stack silently truncates anything larger than MTU–3.
6. **Prints one line to serial**, for example: `#105 bpm=72 spo2=99 q=0.83 R=0.439 maxim=136/99 ir=256361 finger=1 win=999ms ovf=0 link=up mtu=247 len=472 conns=3 lastdisc=0x13 crc=3771` (`maxim=` is the old reference algorithm, printed only for comparison; `ovf` counts sensor samples dropped because we fell behind, and should be 0; `conns / lastdisc` show how many times the Pi connected and why the last link ended, as an HCI reason code).

Bluetooth settings:

- Advertises as `SteeringWheelESP32` with the Nordic UART Service UUIDs.
- Transmit power is **+9 dBm**, the maximum. The default was +3 dBm.
- Asks the Pi for a connection interval of 30–50 ms, latency 0 and a supervision timeout of 4 s.

Build settings: flash at **40 MHz DIO**. At the default 80 MHz QIO this board failed its boot checksum and rebooted in a loop.

4. Signal processing and algorithms

Filtering chain (on the ESP32)

STAGE	WHAT	WHY
On-chip	18-bit sigma-delta ADC, 411 μ s pulses, ambient-light cancellation in the MAX30102	clean raw optical signal
Decimation	mean of each 4 consecutive 100 Hz samples $\rightarrow$ 25 Hz	box-car low-pass; cuts high-frequency noise, and 25 Hz is plenty for heart rate
Baseline removal	subtract a centred 1-second moving average	removes DC and slow drift (breathing, pressure changes)
Smoothing	3-tap filter, -3 dB near 8 Hz at 25 Hz	smooths noise but keeps the pulse harmonics
Finger gate	IR DC $\geq 100\,000$ counts	measured: finger $\approx 242\,000$, object resting $\approx 50\,400$, open air $\approx 1\,100$
Plausibility	BPM 30–220, SpO ₂ 70–100	anything outside is flagged as not usable

Heart rate: autocorrelation (`ppg_vitals.h`)

- Works on 8 s of the pulsatile infrared signal at 25 Hz.
- Computes the normalised autocorrelation and takes the first peak that reaches **0.5** or more as the beat period.
- Refines that peak with parabolic interpolation, giving sub-sample precision.
- Heart rate = 60 / period.
- The peak's height (0–1) is the **quality** score sent in every packet.

It replaced Maxim's reference algorithm. On this hardware, Maxim's median was 115 BPM when independent estimates said 79–80. It counts the diastolic notch as an extra beat. The new estimator's median was 65 BPM with a standard deviation of 3.3.

SpO₂: ratio of ratios

- $R = (AC_{red} / DC_{red}) / (AC_{ir} / DC_{ir})$, where AC is the RMS over the window.
- R is looked up in Maxim's own calibration table (`uch_spo2_table`), so the calibration is the manufacturer's.

On the Pi: a 5-point moving average of usable readings, for the display only.

On the phone and website, summaries use percentiles, not min/max. PPG on a steering wheel picks up grip and motion artifacts, and a single bad second would otherwise become the "highest heart rate" of a drive.

- **Realistic low** = 5th percentile, **typical** = median, **realistic high** = 95th percentile. Min and max are still shown in small print.
- The phone and the database use the same percentile definition (linear interpolation, like `Postgres percentile_cont`), so they report identical numbers. This is unit-tested.

Why 100 Hz raw data matters. Mean heart rate needs only a low sampling rate. Pulse-rate variability is reliable at 25 Hz or more in healthy subjects (Choi & Shin 2017). RMSSD and frequency-domain HRV need about 100–200 Hz unless you interpolate (Béres et al. 2019). Sending every 100 Hz sample keeps those analyses possible for the team's future algorithm work.

5. The radio packet (protocol v3)

One packet per second. Little-endian. The CRC is computed by the ESP32 and checked by the Pi, the phone and the laptop.

OFFSET	SIZE	FIELD	NOTES
0	2	magic <code>0xA55A</code>	on the wire <code>5A A5</code>
2	1	version	3
3	1	flags	1 = HR valid, 2 = SpO ₂ valid, 4 = finger, 8 = in range
4	4	seq	+1 per second, restarts at 0 when the ESP32 reboots
8	4	t0_ms	ESP32 clock at the first sample
12	2	rate_hz	100
14	1	n	samples in this packet (100)
15	1	quality	0–100
16	2	heart_rate	BPM, –999 = no result
18	2	spo2	%, –999 = no result
20	[36n/8]	samples	n × {red:18 bits, IR:18 bits}, bit-packed
end	2	CRC-16/CCITT-FALSE	check value <code>0x29B1</code>

- Sample i was taken at `t0_ms + i × 1000 / rate_hz`, on the sensor's own clock.
- v3 carries **12.5× the samples of v2 for 4.5× the bytes**. v2 sent 8 of the 100 samples in 104 bytes. The 18 bits match the sensor's ADC exactly, so no data is lost.
- The receivers also decode v2, so old captures still read.
- **The deframer** reassembles packets from Bluetooth pieces of any size. It resynchronises on the magic bytes after corruption. If it has buffered a false header, it looks ahead for a complete valid packet instead of waiting on the false one.
- **Implementations are kept in lock-step by tests:**
 - C++ `ppg_frame.h` (encoder)
 - Python `system/common/ppg_protocol.py`
 - TypeScript `mobile-app/lib/ble/protocol.ts`

Both the Python and TypeScript test suites decode packets produced by the compiled firmware encoder.

Bluetooth IDs

	SERVICE	CHARACTERISTIC
ESP32	6e400001-b5a3-f393-e0a9-e50e24dcca9e	TX notify 6e400003-...
Pi relay (PPG-Relay - Pi)	5b1e0001-7c2d-4f6a-9e3b-8a4c2d1f6e01	frames 5b1e0002-... (notify), status JSON 5b1e0003-... (read)

6. Raspberry Pi relay

Files (in `system/pi/` , installed to `~/PPG_Logger` on the Pi):

- `ppg_relay.py` — one asyncio process that:
 - connects to the ESP32 as a Bluetooth central (bleak) and verifies every packet;
 - logs processed values to `~/PPG_Logger/logs/ppg_data.csv` (owner-only permissions, umask 077). Columns: timestamp, spo2, avg_spo2, bpm, avg_bpm, seq, esp times, validity flags, quality, protocol, samples, rate_hz;
 - runs a GATT server and advertisement for the phone (dbus-fast → BlueZ), forwarding each packet unchanged in MTU-sized pieces;
 - writes live state to `/run/ppg-relay/state.json` for the dashboard;
 - retries the phone-side service every 5 s if Bluetooth is off at boot;
 - backs off between failed ESP32 attempts, from 1 s up to 15 s;
 - releases BlueZ links orphaned by a crash.
- `ppg_monitor.py` — the terminal dashboard. It opens automatically at boot and shows the links, vitals with sparklines, latest packets, counters (including the packet format and bytes/s) and events. `ppg-monitor --once` prints one frame.
- `setup_pi.sh` — one-shot installer (`sudo bash setup_pi.sh`). It:
 - installs bluez and python3-venv;
 - unblocks and powers Bluetooth;
 - writes the [LE] connection and scan parameters to `/etc/bluetooth/main.conf`;
 - builds a venv from the bundled wheels in `pi/wheels/` , so no internet is needed;
 - installs the systemd service `ppg-relay` (`Restart=always` , `UMask=0077`);
 - sets the dashboard to autostart.

Options: `--no-service` , `--no-dashboard` , `--uninstall` .

- **Raw samples are off by default.** `--log-raw` stores them for development only.

Important: the Pi 5's Wi-Fi and Bluetooth share one radio and antenna. Measured on the bench:

- While the Pi's Wi-Fi was on 2.4 GHz, the ESP32 link failed to establish (HCI reason `0x3E`) again and again.
- Switching Bluetooth on made Wi-Fi glitch.
- **With Wi-Fi off, the link held steadily.**

What to do about it:

- **In the car:** keep Wi-Fi off (`sudo nmcli radio wifi off`). Nothing on the Pi needs it.
- **On the bench:** the relay now scans at a 25% duty cycle and backs off after failures. It is still best to use Ethernet, or to keep Wi-Fi off while testing Bluetooth.

- **Placement:** keep the ESP32 within about 1–2 m of the Pi, and never with a laptop or other metal between them. The Pi heard the ESP32 at -93 dBm with a laptop in between, which is at the limit of sensitivity.

7. Phone app

React Native (Expo SDK 54), TypeScript, in `mobile-app/`.

Screens

- **Who's driving?** — pick, add or edit a driver: name, subject ID, age, weight, height (the app shows **BMI** live), gender, health conditions, medications, voice language and an emergency contact. To edit, long-press a driver. Once in, **Switch driver** in the header goes back; if a drive is recording, it is ended and saved first.
- **Drive**
 - Phone → Pi → Wheel connection chain.
 - Big heart-rate and oxygen tiles.
 - 2-minute charts, with the driver's usual range shaded.
 - Start/End drive.
 - A **Data flow** card with a live dot that moves with the bytes/s coming from the wheel, plus the bytes/s sent to the cloud.
- **History** — past drives with realistic low / typical / realistic high, alerts, and **Unfold waveform** for full-waveform drives. Unfold checks the SHA-256, decompresses, and shows 10 s of red and IR.
- **Settings**
 - What to save (§10).
 - **Safety checks:** this driver's thresholds, how the profile set them, the voice-check status, and **Try the voice check** (§11).
 - Upload waiting drives.
 - Auto-connect on/off.
 - Link health counters.
 - Bench-only "connect straight to ESP32".

How it connects: it scans for the Pi relay only and reconnects by itself, backing off 1, 2, 4, then 8 s. It retries immediately when the app returns to the foreground. Direct-to-ESP32 is off by default: the ESP32 accepts one connection, so a phone holding it would lock the Pi out.

Sessions

- One reading per second is stored in SQLite: BPM and SpO₂ only when "usable", plus finger, quality and the time received.
- If the ESP32 restarts mid-drive (its sequence jumps backwards), the app closes the session and continues in a new one, so nothing collides.

Live upload (`lib/db/liveSync.ts`) runs every second. It pushes the driver, the session (with a heartbeat: `last_seen_at` and a `link_state` of streaming / sensor_lost / pi_lost), new readings and alerts. At the end of a drive it also uploads the folded archive to Storage. If the database hasn't had the v3 update, it falls back to the older columns instead of failing.

Install on an iPhone. There is no paid Apple account, so the app is sideloaded:

1. Push to the build repo, and GitHub Actions builds an unsigned `.ipa`. See `.github/workflows/ios-build.yml`: it installs, typechecks, runs the unit tests, runs `expo prebuild` and `xcodebuild`, then packages the file.
2. Download the artifact.
3. Sign and install it with **iload** and a free Apple ID. Run `apploader` on the dev laptop.
4. On the phone: **Settings** → **General** → **VPN & Device Management** → **Trust**, with Developer Mode on.

Free signing certificates expire after **7 days**. Then the app shows "no longer available"; reinstall to renew.

Supabase URL and publishable key: in CI they come from the repository secrets `EXPO_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL` and `EXPO_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY`, written to `.env` at build time.

8. Cloud: Supabase

Run these in **Supabase** → **SQL Editor**, in this order. Each is safe to re-run.

1. `mobile-app/supabase/schema.sql` — creates:
 - tables `driver_profiles`, `drive_sessions`, `telemetry_events`;
 - the view `session_summaries`;
 - prototype row-level security.
2. `mobile-app/supabase/live.sql` — turns on Realtime. It also adds a bridge to the old `test_readings` table, which step 3 retires.
3. `mobile-app/supabase/v3_dashboard.sql` — adds:
 - the session heartbeat, plus finger and quality on each reading;
 - **percentile summaries**, the `driver_baselines` view and the `active_sessions` view;
 - `session_archives` and the private Storage bucket `session-archives`;
 - `drive_alerts`;
 - Realtime on all live tables;
 - and it removes the bridge.
4. `mobile-app/supabase/v4_flags.sql` — adds:
 - profile `conditions`, `medications` and `language`;
 - a `bmi` column computed by the database;
 - alert `level`, `channel` and `answer_confidence`.

The emergency contact is deliberately not stored in the cloud.

All primary keys are UUIDs made on the phone, so uploads are idempotent upserts.

9. Website dashboard

`website/` is Vite with vanilla JS modules. It is deployed on Vercel at <https://smart-wheel-dashboard.vercel.app>.

- **Live**
 - Every active drive appears on its own, with no refresh.
 - When exactly one is active, a big live chart opens, with the driver's usual range drawn behind it.
 - State pills show Streaming / No finger / Sensor lost / Phone quiet, and alert banners appear here too.
 - When a drive ends, its card turns into the summary: realistic low/high, median, average, duration and usable %.
- **Drives** — history with paginated charts, alerts, and **Unfold waveform**. Unfold downloads the `.ppga` file from Storage, checks its SHA-256, and plots the red and IR waveforms with zoom.
- **Drivers** — each driver's baseline, or "learning" until there is enough data.
- **Developer feed** — the team's original `test_readings` table.
- It shows a setup banner if `v3_dashboard.sql` hasn't been run.

Local run: `cd website && npm install`, create `website/.env` with `VITE_SUPABASE_URL=...` and `VITE_SUPABASE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY=...`, then `npm run dev`.

Deploy:

```
npx vercel link
npx vercel env add VITE_SUPABASE_URL production
npx vercel env add VITE_SUPABASE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY production
npx vercel deploy --prod
```

10. Data policy, storage and backups

The proposal's policy ("Option 3"): keep processed values, not raw PPG, with restricted permissions. The app follows it by default and makes raw storage an explicit, informed choice.

MODE (SETTINGS → WHAT TO SAVE)	STORED
Vitals only (default)	BPM, SpO ₂ , finger and quality once per second. No raw samples anywhere.
Vitals + full waveform	The above, plus every raw red/IR sample, folded into an archive at the end of the drive. Use only with the driver's consent.

The folded archive ("PPGA") works like folding a long poem to keep it: small to store, and it opens back exactly when you need it. `mobile-app/lib/archive/codecs.ts` has the full byte layout.

1. **Predict each value from the previous ones.** A fixed polynomial predictor of order 0–3 is chosen per column, the same idea as FLAC's "fixed" predictors (RFC 9639). A smooth PPG waveform leaves tiny leftovers ("residuals").
2. **Store the residuals compactly:** zigzag + LEB128 variable-length integers, so small numbers take 1–2 bytes instead of 4.
3. **DEFLATE-compress the result** (LZ77 + Huffman).
4. **Verify before deleting anything.** The phone unfolds the archive and compares every sample with the original. Only then does it clear the raw copy, in one database transaction. A **SHA-256** checksum is stored and checked every time the archive is opened, on the phone or the website.

On synthetic 100 Hz PPG this folds 2 minutes from 96 KB to 22 KB, **4.4×** and lossless. Published lossless compression of biosignals using prediction plus entropy coding reports about 3–4×

 (Bannajak et al. 2023). Expect about 4× on real data. Confirm this on your own recordings.

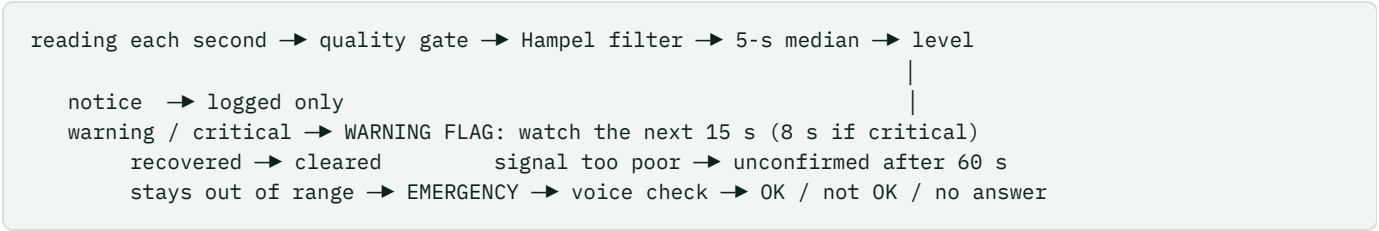
Backups (3-2-1 rule): three copies, on two kinds of storage, one off-site (CISA / US-CERT "Data Backup Options").

- **Copy 1:** the phone's database.
- **Copy 2:** Supabase (off-site). Readings, summaries and the `.ppga` archive in Storage.
- **Copy 3:** the Pi's SD card CSV of processed values.

Supabase encrypts data at rest (AES-256) and in transit (TLS).

11. Warning and emergency system

This section covers how a reading becomes a **warning flag**, how a warning becomes an **emergency**, and what the phone does next. All of it runs **on the phone**. The website only displays the results.



11.1 What is "normal" for this driver (the profile)

The profile form collects:

- age, sex, height and weight (the app computes **BMI** from these and shows it live);
- health conditions: high blood pressure, diabetes, high cholesterol, arrhythmia, sleep apnea, asthma, COPD, coronary artery disease, prior heart attack, heart failure, peripheral vascular disease, prior stroke;
- medications: beta blocker, non-DHP calcium-channel blocker, amiodarone, inhaled beta-agonist;
- the voice-check language (English or Spanish);
- an optional emergency contact, which **stays on the phone**.

Long-press a driver to edit their profile.

The expected heart rate is computed in `lib/analysis/profileModel.ts` , in three layers.

1. Population prior. This is your reference workbook's layer. It uses real-world smartphone-PPG norms from Avram et al. 2019 (66,788 people):

- It starts from the age-group mean ± SD (18–20: 81.6 ± 14.0 ... 61–70: 73.0 ± 12.7).
- It then applies the paper's multivariable coefficients:

FACTOR	ADJUSTMENT
Sex	female +2.1 BPM, male –2.1 BPM (half of the +4.28 female–male difference)
BMI	+0.21 BPM per kg/m² relative to 27.5
Conditions	diabetes +4.48, sleep apnea +3.67, COPD +2.49, hypertension +1.83, arrhythmia +1.65, asthma +1.51, high cholesterol +1.35
Medications	non-DHP calcium-channel blocker +4.11

Effects the paper found **not significant** (beta blockers, amiodarone, CAD, prior MI, CHF, PVD, stroke; $p \geq 0.05$) are recorded but not applied. Every adjustment is listed in the app under **Settings** → **Safety checks**, so the numbers can always be explained.

2. Personal baseline. The 10th, 50th and 90th percentiles of the driver's own finished drives. They gradually replace the prior, with weight $w = n / (n + 600)$: 10 minutes of good signal counts as much as the whole population prior. The SD never goes below 6 BPM.

3. Clinical bands (NEWS2). These are the same for everyone, because a dangerous value is dangerous whoever you are:

- Pulse: ≤ 40 scores 3, 41–50 scores 1, 51–90 scores 0, 91–110 scores 1, 111–130 scores 2, ≥ 131 scores 3.
- SpO₂ Scale 1: ≤ 91 scores 3, 92–93 scores 2, 94–95 scores 1.
- SpO₂ Scale 2 (confirmed hypercapnic COPD only): ≤ 83 scores 3, 84–85 scores 2, 86–87 scores 1.

COPD drivers are the exception for oxygen. People with stable COPD live at a lower normal saturation:

- In Little et al. 1999 (33 stable, normoxic or mildly hypoxic patients), awake SaO₂ was **93.9 ± 1.6 %**. That sits inside Scale 1's warning band, so Scale 1 would flag them all day long.
- The same paper defines a clinically significant desaturation as a **fall of more than 4 points from the person's own awake baseline**.

So for a driver whose profile includes COPD, oxygen is judged against **their baseline**: 93.9 % to start, then their own learned median once it is established.

- Notice: a 3-point fall.
- Warning: a fall of more than 4 points.
- Critical: ≤ 85 %, the NEWS2 Scale 2 score-2 band.

Scale 2 is not applied wholesale because it requires blood-gas-confirmed hypercapnia, which a profile cannot know.

11.2 Levels

LEVEL	HEART RATE	SPO ₂	WHAT HAPPENS
Notice	NEWS2 1 and ≥ 2.5 SD from the driver's band	94–95 % (COPD: 3-point fall)	logged only
Warning	NEWS2 2 (111–130), or NEWS2 1 and ≥ 3 SD from the band	92–93 % (COPD: fall of more than 4 points)	warning flag, then confirmation
Critical	≤ 40 or ≥ 131 (NEWS2 3)	≤ 91 % (COPD: ≤ 85 %)	warning flag, then short confirmation

For a typical 30-year-old man of normal weight with no history, the warning lines work out to **above 111** and **below 41 BPM**. An athlete whose learned baseline is around 50 BPM is not flagged at 47. Someone whose normal is 62 is warned at 91, because that is both clinically elevated and 3 SD above their normal.

11.3 Warning → emergency ("watch the next seconds")

1. **Quality gate.** A second counts only if:
- the finger is on the sensor;

- both vitals are valid;
- pulse periodicity is $\geq 50 \%$.

Bad seconds count as *missing*; never as normal, never as abnormal.

2. **Hampel filter.** A single second that disagrees with its 7-second neighbourhood by more than $3 \times 1.4826 \times \text{MAD}$ is dropped. The minimum distance is 8 BPM or 3 % SpO₂.

3. **5-second median** decides the level.

4. **Confirmation window.** A warning-level median raises the **warning flag** and starts watching:

- **15 s** at warning level, **8 s** at critical level;
- it becomes an **emergency** only if $\geq 70 \%$ of those seconds had an accepted reading **and** $\geq 80 \%$ of them were beyond the line;
- if the median comes back (5 BPM / 1 % hysteresis), the flag clears as *recovered*;
- with too little signal for 60 s, it closes as *unconfirmed*.

Why wait? Alarm research shows short delays remove most non-actionable alarms. A 14-s delay removed 50 % and a 19-s delay 67 % of ignored or ineffective ICU alarms (Görge et al. 2009). A 6-s delay halved SpO₂ alarms (Rheineck-Leyssius & Kalkman 1998).

5. **After the check.** After "I'm OK" the same kind stays quiet for 5 minutes. If it gets worse (warning → critical) it re-arms immediately.

6. **Learning from "I'm OK".** If the driver answers OK to a **warning-level** heart-rate check, that value was evidently normal for them:

- their warning line in that direction moves to the episode's peak + 5 BPM (– 5 for low), and is saved per driver;
- limits keep this safe: the high line never passes **125**, the low line never goes below **43**, so the critical lines ($\geq 131, \leq 40$) always still ask;
- critical episodes and oxygen never adapt;
- Settings → Safety checks shows any adjustment, with **Reset**.

7. **No hand on the sensor** for 15 s during a drive raises a notice. It is not an emergency by itself: the sensor simply cannot see anything.

11.4 The voice check (phone only, free, offline)

When an emergency is confirmed, the phone vibrates, then:

1. It **speaks**, using the phone's own text-to-speech (iOS AVSpeechSynthesizer via `expo-speech`) and the best installed voice for the language. "Enhanced" voices are free downloads on iPhone. For example: "Luis, your heart rate has been unusually high. Are you feeling okay? Please say yes, or no."
2. It **listens for 6 s** with the phone's speech recognizer (`expo-speech-recognition` → Apple SFSpeechRecognizer):

- **on-device when supported**, so audio never leaves the phone;
 - the recognizer is primed with the expected answers.
3. It **understands** the answer with a small local classifier (`lib/voice/intent.ts`). This is a logistic regression over word and character n-grams, about 120 KB of weights, trained by `tools/intent/train.py` on about 4,700 English and Spanish phrasings. Safety rules sit on top of the model:
- **Urgent words** ("help", "911", "ambulance", "chest", "can't breathe", "ayuda", ...) → *not OK + urgent*, unless negated ("I don't need help").
 - **Explicit negation** ("not okay", "I don't feel well", "no estoy bien") → *not OK*.
 - **The model** decides "not OK" at ≥ 0.5 probability, but "OK" only at ≥ 0.75 . Anything in between counts as unclear. A wrong "OK" is the one mistake that matters, so "OK" needs the most evidence.
4. **Unclear or silence**: it asks once more, more simply. Still no clear answer → **no response**, which is treated like "not OK" (per the proposal).
5. **Outcome**:
- "OK" → "I'll keep an eye on things."
 - "Not OK" or no answer → "Please pull over as soon as it is safe. If you need emergency help, call 911." It is recorded as **escalated (simulated)**.

The wording never claims help is on the way, because in this prototype nobody is contacted.

6. **The on-screen buttons** ("I'm OK" / "I'm not OK") work at any moment and on any tab. They also cover phones where the microphone isn't allowed.

The voice check only reacts to flags. It never analyses the vitals. Transcripts are used in memory only and are **never stored or uploaded**. Only the outcome, the channel (voice or button) and the classifier's confidence are saved.

Classifier accuracy.

- Held-out set: 63 hand-written phrases, never used for training → **63/63 correct, 0 "not OK" heard as "OK"**.
- The phone's probabilities match the Python trainer's to 10^{-4} (parity test).
- Caveat: the held-out set was consulted once to add Spanish negation examples, so it is no longer perfectly blind.
- **Next step**: record real answers from team members (with road noise) and add them as a new test set.

Try it: Settings → **Try the voice check** runs the real dialogue without recording anything.

Demo — trigger a warning (Settings) plays **fabricated readings** through a fresh copy of the real engine, using this driver's thresholds, at 4× real time:

- **Scenarios**: very high heart rate (critical), high heart rate (warning, 15-s check), very low heart rate, low oxygen.
- **What you see**: about 10 normal seconds, then abnormal ones. The Drive tab shows the warning flag and the confirmation, then the real voice check asks if you're OK.
- **Nothing is kept**: nothing is saved, uploaded, or learned from.
- **Timing**: a demo takes about 5–10 real seconds to reach the voice check.

11.5 Irregular-rhythm advisory

Modelled on Apple's Irregular Rhythm Notification (Apple, *Using Apple Watch for Arrhythmia Detection*, Dec 2020). It is an **advisory shown after the drive, never an emergency and never a diagnosis**.

1. **Beats.** The Elgendi et al. 2013 detector runs on the 100 Hz infrared PPG:

- 0.5–8 Hz zero-phase band-pass, clip, square;
- moving averages over 111 ms and 667 ms, with offset $\beta = 0.02$;
- reported 99.84 % sensitivity.

2. **Segments.** Each segment is 128 beat intervals from *continuous* clean signal. Any bad second or lost packet restarts it, following Apple's rule of analysing only when there is enough signal.

3. **Irregular** means all three of the Dash et al. 2009 measures hold:

- RMSSD / mean ≥ 0.098 ;
- Shannon entropy ≥ 0.8 ;
- turning-point ratio within 0.527–0.8.

Dash reported 94.4 % sensitivity and 95.1 % specificity on MIT-BIH AF; the thresholds come from the authors' patent.

4. **Five of six** consecutive irregular segments → advisory. Two regular segments reset the count (Apple). In the Apple Heart Study sub-study, 78.9 % of notified people had AFib confirmed by ECG patch.

11.6 What gets recorded

Every episode becomes a `drive_alerts` row, which appears on the website live:

- `kind` — the type of episode;
- `level` — notice, warning or critical;
- `value` — the most extreme 5-s median;
- `threshold` — the line it crossed;
- `started_at`, `prompted_at` — when it started and when the driver was asked;
- `response` — `ok`, `not_ok`, `no_response`, `recovered` or `unconfirmed`;
- `channel` — voice or button;
- `answer_confidence`, and `escalated`.

The website shows a banner only for real warnings being confirmed and for emergencies, not for notices.

Tested scenarios (`tests/flagEngine.test.ts`, `rhythm.test.ts`, `voiceCheck.test.ts`, `intent.test.ts`):

- **Heart rate:**
 - normal driving → no flags;
 - isolated 170-BPM artifacts → rejected;
 - sustained 142 → emergency about 8 s after the flag;

- sustained 118 → emergency after the 15-s window;
- an 8-s burst → cleared as recovered;
- dropouts → closed as unconfirmed.
- **Profiles and oxygen:**
 - an athlete at 47 → not flagged;
 - SpO₂ 89 → emergency, SpO₂ 93 → emergency for a typical driver;
 - a COPD driver at their normal 92–94 % → not flagged, but a drop to 88 % → emergency; with a learned baseline of 96 %, the warning line moves to 91 %.
- **After the check:**
 - the 5-min quiet period holds, and critical re-arms;
 - hands off the wheel → notice only.
- **Rhythm:** sinus rhythm is never advised; AF-like rhythm is advised after 5 of 6 segments; bad signal is never analysed.
- **Voice dialogue:** yes / unclear → no / silence×2 / urgent / Spanish / button mid-listen.

These thresholds are prototype values built from published references. They are not clinically validated for this device. Validating them on real drives is future work.

12. Setting up a development machine (any Linux)

1. System packages

DISTRO	COMMAND
Debian / Ubuntu / Raspberry Pi OS	<code>sudo apt install git python3 python3-venv python3-pip g++ bluez curl chromium</code>
Fedora	<code>sudo dnf install git python3 python3-pip gcc-c++ bluez curl chromium</code>
Arch / Manjaro / Omarchy	<code>sudo pacman -S git python python-pip gcc bluez bluez-utils curl chromium</code>
openSUSE	<code>sudo zypper install git python3 python3-pip gcc-c++ bluez curl chromium</code>

Then enable Bluetooth: `sudo systemctl enable --now bluetooth`.

2. Node.js 22. Use a version manager so every distro gets the same version:

```
curl -fsSL https://fnm.vercel.app/install | bash      # then open a new terminal
fnm install 22 && fnm default 22
node --version                                     # v22.x or newer
```

3. The code

```
git clone <repo-url> fiu-senior && cd fiu-senior
git checkout luis/full-system
```

4. ESP32 toolchain

```
curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/arduino/arduino-cli/master/install.sh | BINDIR=~/.local/bin
sh
~/.local/bin/arduino-cli config init
~/.local/bin/arduino-cli config add board_manager.additional_urls https://espressif.github.io/arduino-
esp32/package_esp32_index.json
~/.local/bin/arduino-cli core update-index
~/.local/bin/arduino-cli core install esp32:esp32@3.3.12
~/.local/bin/arduino-cli lib install "SparkFun MAX3010x Pulse and Proximity Sensor Library@1.1.2"
```

Serial-port access for the ESP32's CP210x chip, needed once per machine. Replug the ESP32 afterwards:

```
echo 'SUBSYSTEM=="tty", ATTRS{idVendor}=="10c4", ATTRS{idProduct}=="ea60", TAG+="uaccess"' | sudo tee
/etc/udev/rules.d/70-esp32-cp210x.rules
sudo udevadm control --reload-rules && sudo udevadm trigger
```

5. Python tools (laptop viewer, esptool)

```
python3 -m venv ~/ppg-venv
~/ppg-venv/bin/pip install bleak==3.0.2 dbus-fast pyqtgraph PySide6 pyserial esptool rich numpy
```

6. Retraining the voice-answer model (only needed if you change the phrases in `mobile-app/tools/intent/phrases.py`). It needs Python 3 with numpy:

```
cd mobile-app && python3 tools/intent/train.py && python3 tools/intent/check.py && npm test
```

It prints the held-out accuracy and the number of critical errors ("not OK" heard as "OK"). That number must stay 0.

7. Phone app and website dependencies

```
cd mobile-app && npm ci && npm test && cd ..
cd website && npm ci && cd ..
```

13. Everyday commands

TASK	COMMAND
Flash the ESP32 (USB)	<code>system/esp32/flash_esp32.sh</code> (optional port: <code>/dev/ttyUSB0</code>)
Watch the ESP32	<code>~/local/bin/arduino-cli monitor -p /dev/ttyUSB0 -c baudrate=115200</code> (opening the port resets the board)
Install/refresh the Pi	copy <code>system/pi/</code> to the Pi (USB stick or <code>scp -r system/pi pi:</code>), then on the Pi: <code>sudo bash setup_pi.sh</code>
Pi service status / logs	<code>systemctl status ppg-relay · journalctl -u ppg-relay -f</code>
Pi dashboard	<code>ppg-monitor</code> (starts automatically at boot)
Pi Wi-Fi off / on	<code>sudo nmcli radio wifi off · sudo nmcli radio wifi on</code>
Laptop viewer	<code>system/laptop/run_viewer.sh</code> (via the Pi) · <code>--direct</code> (ESP32) · <code>--demo</code> (no hardware)
Python tests	<code>cd system && python3 -m unittest discover -s tests -v</code>
App tests + typecheck	<code>cd mobile-app && npm test && npm run typecheck</code>
Build the iPhone app	push the branch to the build repo → Actions → download <code>SmartWheelApp-unsigned-ipa</code>
Install on iPhone	<code>apploader</code> (opens iloader with the newest <code>.ipa</code> path on the clipboard)
Retrain / check the voice-answer model	<code>cd mobile-app && python3 tools/intent/train.py · python3 tools/intent/check.py</code>
Website locally	<code>cd website && npm run dev</code> → <code>http://localhost:5173</code>
Deploy website	<code>cd website && npx vercel deploy --prod</code>

14. Tests

SUITE	WHAT IT PROVES
<code>system/tests/test_protocol.py</code> (20 tests)	CRC check value; v2 and v3 round-trip; every single-bit flip is detected ; deframing at any chunk size; resync after garbage and false headers; the Python decoder reads packets from the compiled firmware encoder and the Python encoder reproduces them byte for byte; the shared modules in <code>pi/</code> and <code>laptop/</code> match the master copy
<code>system/tests/test_vitals_hoist.cpp</code>	the heart-rate/SpO ₂ estimator on 45 synthetic signals with known answers
<code>mobile-app/tests/protocol.test.ts</code>	the phone decodes packets from the compiled firmware encoder; bit flips; mixed v2/v3 streams at Bluetooth chunk sizes; the false-header look-ahead
<code>mobile-app/tests/codecs.test.ts</code>	folding is lossless, handles edge cases, rejects corruption; reports the compression ratio
<code>mobile-app/tests/flagEngine.test.ts</code>	profile prior = Avram coefficients; NEWS2 bands; 11 driving scenarios: artifacts rejected, critical and warning confirmation windows, recovery, poor signal, athlete baseline, SpO ₂ scales, cooldown and re-arm, no contact
<code>mobile-app/tests/rhythm.test.ts</code>	beat detection on a synthetic PPG; sinus vs AF-like intervals; 5-of-6 advisory; bad signal never analysed
<code>mobile-app/tests/intent.test.ts</code>	the phone's hashing and probabilities equal the Python trainer's; held-out phrases with zero critical errors; safety rules (urgent words, negation, "no, I'm fine", Spanish)
<code>mobile-app/tests/voiceCheck.test.ts</code>	the spoken dialogue: yes, unclear then no, silence twice, urgent, Spanish, a button press mid-listen
<code>mobile-app/tests/stats.test.ts</code>	percentiles match Postgres; baseline establishment
<code>mobile-app/tests/shared-sync.test.ts</code>	the website's copy of the codec is byte-identical
SQL	<code>v3_dashboard.sql</code> was run twice on Postgres 17 (PGlite) with the Supabase roles, bucket and publication stubbed

CI runs the app typecheck and unit tests on every build.

15. Measured results

MEASUREMENT	RESULT
Acquisition window	990–1003 ms per 100 samples, 0 FIFO overflows
Packet	v3, 100 samples, 472 bytes, 1 per second
Laptop link (bench)	0 CRC errors, packets every 1.004 s
Heart-rate estimator vs Maxim (same pulse; reference 79–80 BPM)	estimator median 65, σ 3.3 · Maxim median 115
Finger threshold evidence	finger $\approx$ 242 000 · object $\approx$ 50 400 · air $\approx$ 1 100 (IR counts)
Pi ↔ ESP32 with Pi Wi-Fi on (2.4 GHz)	repeated 0x3E failures; the Pi heard the ESP32 at –80 to –93 dBm with a laptop in between
Pi ↔ ESP32 with Pi Wi-Fi off	connected and steady
Archive fold (synthetic, 2 min @ 100 Hz)	96 KB → 22 KB (4.4×), lossless

16. Troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE → FIX
Pi dashboard stuck on SCANNING / connecting then dropping	Wi-Fi/Bluetooth sharing on the Pi 5 or distance → turn Pi Wi-Fi off, keep the ESP32 within 1–2 m with nothing metal between
Pi Wi-Fi glitches when Bluetooth is on	same shared radio → use Ethernet for development, or Wi-Fi off
"phone relay unavailable ... is Bluetooth on?" in the Pi log	Bluetooth was off → switch it on; the relay retries every 5 s by itself
ESP32 serial shows "MAX30102 not found"	wiring. Read the diagnostic line: no pull-ups = power/GND; pull-ups but no ACK = SDA/SCL swapped or wrong pins
ESP32 boot loop, "Checksum failed"	flashed at 80 MHz QIO → use <code>flash_esp32.sh</code> (40 MHz DIO)
App says "no longer available"	the 7-day free signing expired → reinstall with <code>uploader</code>
iPhone: "Untrusted Developer"	Settings → General → VPN & Device Management → trust your Apple ID
Website shows "Database needs the v3 update"	run <code>v3_dashboard.sql</code>
No finger / "Place your hand on the sensor"	the IR level is below 100 000; press a fingertip flat on the sensor
Packet line shows v2 · 8 samples	the ESP32 has old firmware → reflash
The voice check doesn't listen ("buttons only")	the microphone or speech permission was denied → iPhone Settings → Smart Wheel → allow Microphone and Speech Recognition
The voice sounds robotic	download an "Enhanced" voice: iPhone Settings → Accessibility → Spoken Content → Voices
Too many warnings for one driver	check their profile (age, conditions) in Settings → Safety checks; after about 10 minutes of their own drives the thresholds follow their personal normal

17. Security status and before-real-data checklist

The current state is a **closed prototype**:

- Supabase row-level security is **permissive**. Anyone holding the publishable key, which ships inside the app and the website, can read and write every table and archive.
- The website is public at its Vercel URL.
- Bluetooth pairing uses "Just Works", with no passkey.

Before collecting real subject data:

1. Add Supabase Auth and replace the `prototype_all` policies with per-user policies (e.g. `auth.uid() = owner_id`), including the Storage bucket.
2. Put the website behind login (Supabase Auth), or Vercel Deployment Protection.
3. Bluetooth: bond the phone to the Pi, and require encryption on the relay's characteristics.
4. Consider client-side encryption of `.ppga` archives, with the key in the phone's Keychain.
5. Collect written consent, especially for "Vitals + full waveform".

18. How this maps to the proposal

PROPOSAL ITEM	STATUS
PPG sensing on the wheel, ESP32 preprocessing, BPM/SpO ₂	✓ MAX30102 + ESP32, estimator in §4
Sensor polling 25–250 Hz	✓ 100 Hz, all samples transmitted
Baseline acquisition 6–8 s	✓ 8 s analysis window
Wireless ESP32 → Pi (BLE)	✓ with CRC and end-to-end verification
Filter environmental and electrical noise	✓ decimation, baseline removal, smoothing, finger gate, plausibility, 10-s median for alerts, percentile summaries
User profiles and baselines	✓ driver picker, per-driver baseline (phone and cloud)
Real-time display	✓ phone app, Pi dashboard, live website
Store processed, time-stamped data; raw not primary	✓ vitals-only default; raw is opt-in and folded
Encryption and restricted permissions	• TLS + AES-256 at rest (Supabase), owner-only files on the Pi; per-user access control is on the checklist in §17
Baseline comparison per user profile	✓ profile prior from age, sex, BMI, conditions and medications, blended with the learned personal baseline (§11.1)
Alert → driver response → escalation	✓ warning flag → confirmation window → spoken "Are you feeling okay?" with on-device speech understanding → escalation simulated (as specified)
Haptic / non-visual alert	✓ vibration plus a spoken check (eyes stay on the road); a haptic motor in the wheel is future hardware
Hands-off-wheel alert (survey request)	✓ no-contact notice after 15 s
Website always available	✓ Vercel
Pi touchscreen UI	• the terminal dashboard runs on the Pi's screen; a touch GUI is future work
Multiple PPG sensing points	• one sensor today; the protocol's per-packet sample count and flags leave room to add channels in a v4
Machine-learning assessment	• not yet; the 100 Hz raw archives are the training data it will need

19. References

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<https://www.raspberrypi.com/news/introducing-raspberry-pi-5/>

Three claims are engineering reasoning rather than cited findings:

- The combination rules (for example "warning = NEWS2 1 **and** ≥ 3 SD from the personal band", the 15-s / 8-s windows, the 70 % / 80 % confirmation fractions) are our design built on the sources above. They have not been validated on this device.
- "Percentiles instead of min/max for summaries" follows from the artifact literature above but is not taken from a specific paper.
- "Wi-Fi on the Pi degrades our BLE link" is based on our own bench measurements (§15), not on a vendor statement.